

The Placebo Effect: Physiology of Belief

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The Placebo Effect: Physiology of Belief

- **Placebo:** a fake treatment, no active medicine
- **Effect:** real improvement from belief
- **Origin:** Latin "I shall please"

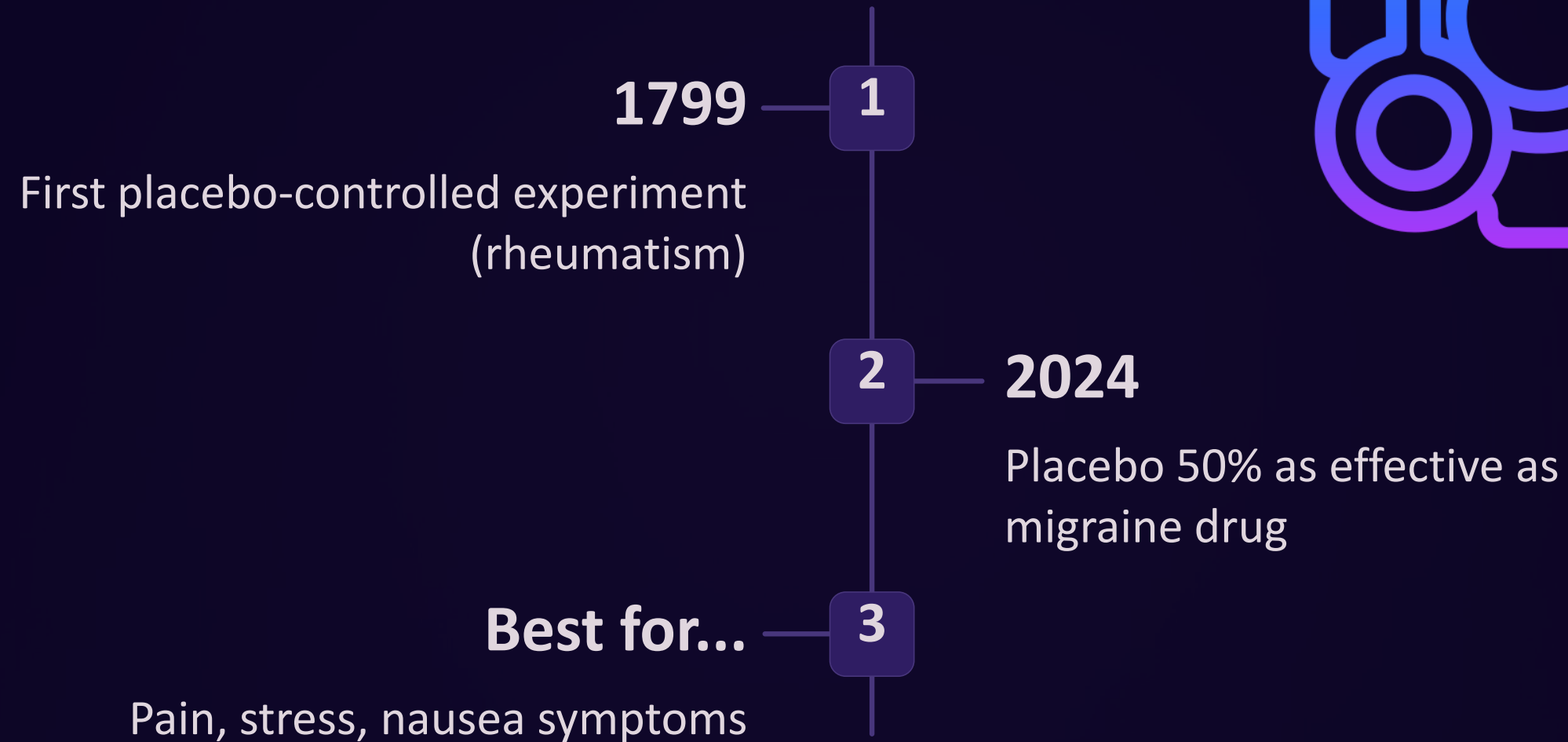




How the Brain Responds

- **Brain areas:** anterior cingulate cortex, cerebellum
- **Releases:** endorphins, dopamine
- Brain-body link changes symptom perception

Key Studies on Placebo



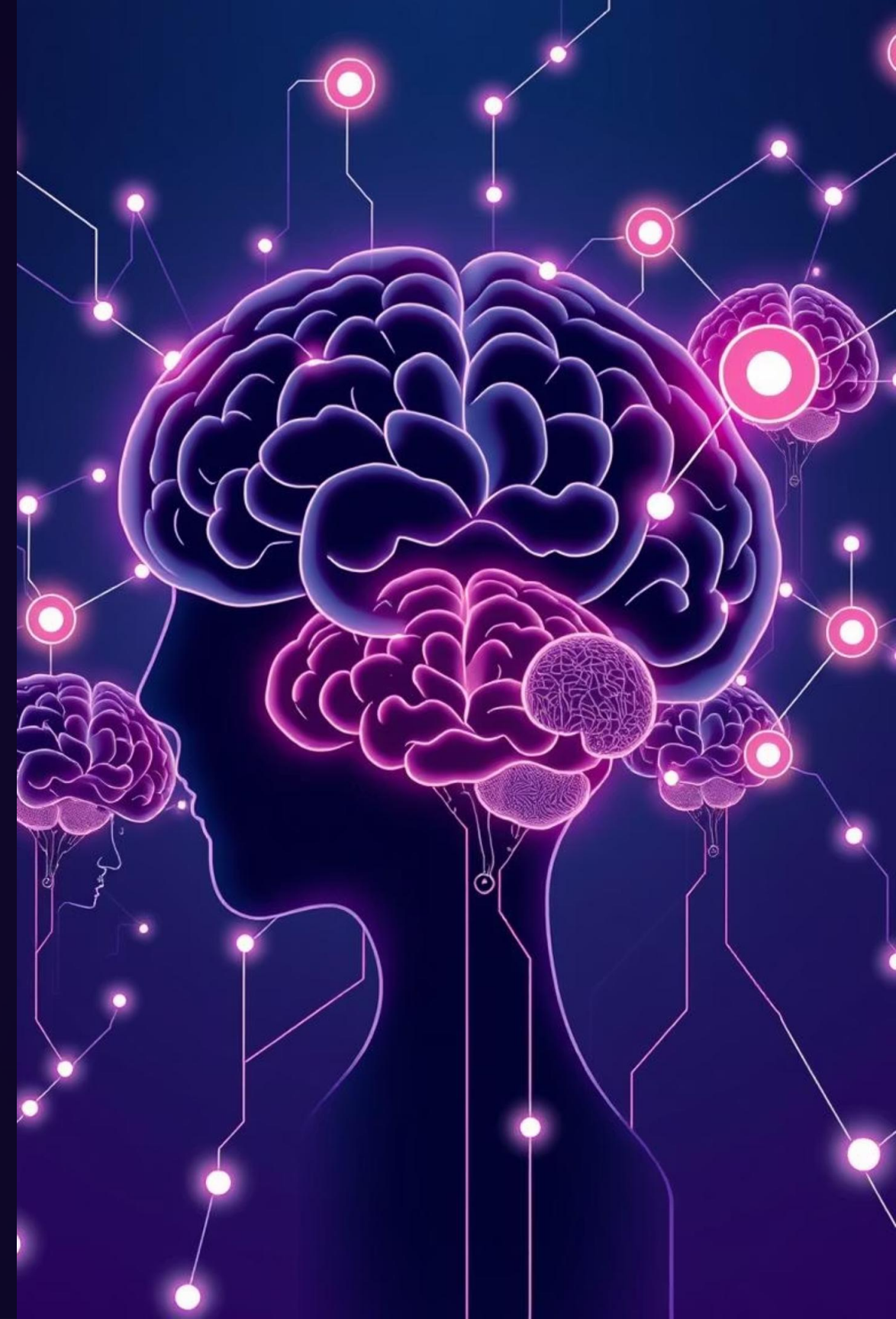
Ethical Considerations

- **Clinical trials:** placebos as controls
- **Debate:** deception vs. informed consent
- Open-label placebos can still help



Conclusion: Power of Belief

- Mind influences body
- Not a cure, but improves symptoms
- Helps improve future treatments



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